

Alarms



It's better to prevent a fire from happening, but fitting alarms will provide an early warning in the event of a fire and allow vital extra time to escape.

CHOOSING AND FITTING YOUR SMOKE ALARMS

Smoke and heat alarms are easy to install. They are available from most DIY and high street supermarkets.

- Fit at least one smoke alarm on every level of your home, and in any room where a fire could start.
- Keep smoke alarms away from kitchens or bathrooms as steam can set them off by mistake.
- Fit a heat alarm in the kitchen. This will

detect the increase in temperature caused by a fire but will not be set off by cooking fumes.

- Choose smoke alarms with a 10 year or long-lasting sealed battery.
- Make sure any alarms you buy are marked with a British Standards or European (CE) safety mark.
- Always follow the manufacturers fitting instructions. Poorly sited alarms may cause lots of false alarms.

MAKING SURE YOUR ALARMS WORK

Fitting alarms save lives, but only if they are working. Test yours every month. It's as simple as pushing the button.

- Change the battery if it starts to bleep on a regular basis.

- Never disconnect or take the batteries out of your alarms if they go off by mistake.
- Some alarms are fitted with 10 year or long-lasting sealed batteries, these should not be removed or replaced as doing so will damage the alarms beyond repair.



Test your alarms every month. It's as simple as pushing the button.

SPECIALIST ALARMS

Where a person has any conditions that may prevent or delay their escape, specialist alarms can be fitted.

- Strobe light and vibrating pad alarms are available for those who are deaf or hard of hearing. For more information contact: Action on Hearing Loss Information Line on 0808 808 0123 or textphone 0808 808 9000.
- Where a telecare monitoring system is fitted, this should be linked to all alarms and sensors in the property.

- Wherever possible fit interlinked alarms throughout your property so that when one alarm detects a fire they all go off together. This will give everyone in your home the earliest warning of fire.
- Mains powered alarms, should be installed by a qualified electrician.

In some circumstances sprinklers or water misting systems may be needed; seek specialist advice from LFB or BAFSA.
www.bafsa.org.uk

Disposal of smoke alarms

Smoke alarms fall under the Waste Electrical and Electronic Equipment (WEEE) Regulations. When the time comes to dispose of your alarm you should

take it to your local civic amenity site (rubbish or re-cycling centre) and place it in the section for WEEE which should be clearly marked.